

SAHAR SHABANI

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Corporate Finance , Corporate Governance , Executive Communication and Behavior , Board Interlock, Firm Disclosure, CEO Turnover.

EDUCATION

University of Ottawa, Telfer School of Management, Ottawa, ON, Canada 2019-2026

Ph.D. in Management - Finance

Dissertation: "Essays on Empirical Corporate Finance"

Amirkabir University of Technology (Tehran Polytechnic), Tehran, Iran 2015-2018

M.Sc. in Industrial Engineering (Financial Engineering)

Amirkabir University of Technology (Tehran Polytechnic) , Tehran, Iran 2010-2015

B.Sc. in Industrial Engineering

PUBLICATIONS

Book Chapter: "The Impact of Coronavirus Pandemic on Bitcoin: A literature Overview." In *Cryptofinance: A New Currency for a New Economy*, Chapter 2, pp. 29-47. With Devinder Gandhi and Shaista Jaffer. World Scientific Publishing Co. Pte. Ltd., 2022.

WORKING PAPERS

"Words Before Exit": CEO Linguistic Patterns and Forced Turnover Outcomes (Job Market Paper)

with Ali Akyol (Advisor)

Presented at the 2026 Financial Management Association (FMA) European Conference.

Received reject and resubmit for Journal of Banking and Finance. We are revising the paper based on comments.

This paper shows that CEOs nearing forced dismissal exhibit distinct linguistic patterns- more first-person, analytical, and power-related language, less authenticity and affect- relative to retained peers. The effect is specific to CEOs rather than CFOs, intensifies sharply as the turnover approaches, and is robust to propensity score matching, entropy balancing, and difference-in-differences designs.

Interlocks in the Shadow: Board Interlocks and Guidance Withdrawal during COVID-19

with Ali Akyol (Advisor)

This paper studies how information travels through board networks, showing that smaller firms are significantly more likely to withdraw earnings guidance shortly after a larger, board-interlocked peer does so. This transmission is substantially stronger when the interlock runs through an audit committee member with relevant financial expertise, indicating that board networks function as a genuine channel for disclosure-relevant information during periods of heightened uncertainty.

What Do All These Vice Presidents Do? Vice Presidents' Employment and Firm Value

This paper examines when the employment of senior vice presidents helps or hurts shareholder value, showing that excess VP employment is associated with lower firm value on average- consistent with agency-cost explanations. This relationship reverses in large, complex organizations and during periods of economic stress, where additional senior management capacity appears to provide genuine coordination and monitoring benefits.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- “Words Before Exit”: CEO Linguistic Patterns and Forced Turnover Outcomes Association (FMA) European Conference* 2026 Financial Management
- Telfer Graduate Student Thesis Competition 2024

TEACHING AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Lecturer

- ADM2352 Finance Theory Spring 2023 / Fall 2023/ Winter 2025 / Spring 2025/ Winter 2026
Number of students: 30 – 92 Average rating of three important questions: 4.29/5.0
- ADM 2303 Business Statistics Spring 2024/ Fall 2024 (two sections)/ Winter 2025/ Fall 2025
Number of students: 60 – 118 Average rating of three important questions: 4.09/5.0

Teaching Assistant

2019-2024

- ADM2352 Finance Theory
- ADM2303 Business Statistics
- ADM4351 Options and Futures
- ADM2350 Financial Management
- ADM4311 Strategic Management
- ADM4356 Alternative Investments and Risk Management
- MHA6351 Health Economics

Research Assistant

- Research Assistant for Professor Samir Saadi 2019-2020
- Research Assistant for Professor Ali Akyol 2026

Work EXPERIENCE

Data Analyst, BamKhodro Trade and Service Company, Tehran, Iran 2016-2019

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Skills: Stata, R, Python, EViews, LaTeX, MATLAB

CERTIFICATIONS

Canadian Securities Institute- Investment Funds in Canada (IFC) 2024

REFERENCES

Dr. Ali Akyol
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Telfer School of Management
University of Ottawa
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Dr. François-Éric Racicot
Full Professor of Finance
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University of Ottawa
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Dr. Shantanu Dutta
Full Professor of Finance
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* Presented by co-author